

One Act Play
"BE PREPARED"

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CHARACTERS: *Campers* - **BOB, JANE, MARY & KATHY**

[SCENE 1]

Kathy: *(enters holding sticks and places them ready for the camp fire)*

BOB: *(enters, blows whistle)* Alright, all campers, please assemble in the clearing for a meeting.

(blows whistle) Please campers, assemble in the clearing for a meeting.

JANE: *(enters)* Hey, who appointed YOU leader, Bob?

MARY: *(enters)* Yeah, where did you get the whistle?

BOB: Alright listen up. Mr. Prescott had to take Lizzy Jacobson to the hospital for her stomach pains.

The other adults are up on the hill setting up for 'Capture the Flag' and the campfire afterward.

KATHY: So, Mr. Prescott appointed YOU for the grand poobah?

BOB: He didn't appoint me anything. He just wanted me to tell you that when he comes back, which will be some time after dark, he wants us all to be ready to play Capture the Flag.

JANE: *(exiting)* What's there to get ready for? It's just a stupid game.

MARY: *(exiting with Kathy)* Yeah, you called a meeting just to tell us that?

BOB: He also gave me money

ALL: (stop in their tracks)

JANE: He what?

KATHY: Did you say money?

BOB: (hands some coins to Jane & Kathy) Mr. Prescott, said that while he's gone, we're all supposed to hike over to the general store at Three Corners to buy an extra set of flashlight batteries, since there will be no moonlight for 'Capture the Flag' tonight.

JANE: (passing out money to Mary) I already have batteries for my flashlight.

KATHY: Me too...I'll give these to Alice, I'm not hiking all the way over to Three Corners just to buy something I already have.

MARY: Me neither, especially when the Way-Side Steak and Grill *(points to opposite side of stage)* is half as far.

BOB: I don't think they would sell flashlight batteries at a steak and grill.

JANE: No, but they DO have Fish n' Chips and milkshakes there. **(tightly holds the money)**

BOB: Guys, Mr. Prescott gave us this money for batteries, NOT for food. Besides, you already got camp food here.

JANE: (exiting) I already have batteries, remember?

KATHY: (following, stuffing money in pocket) Me too, I'm going rollerblading. I'll buy batteries when I

need them.

BOB: (shouting) Guys, Mr. Prescott said that only the winners of Capture the Flag get to go to the campfire and have SMORES.

MARY: Did you say SMORES?

BOB: Yes, but he was real clear. The losers will have to come back here and go to sleep, while the winners get to stuff themselves with...

KATHY: (reenters) SMORES

BOB: Yes

MARY: Chocolate?

BOB: Yes, yes.

KATHY: And marshmallows?

BOB: Yes, but only the winners get them.

JANE: (exiting) I just happen to be an expert at Capture the Flag.

BOB: (loudly) Guys, what about the batteries? *(shrugs, exiting)* Well, if Mr. Prescott thinks we need extra batteries, then I'll hike over and buy them.

[SCENE 2]

(Music)

(Mary, Kathy & Jane enter, tired)

JANE: That was really dirty

KATHY: Yeah, we got gypped. **(points across stage)**. There he is!

BOB: **(yawning, rubbing tummy)** Good morning guys.

MARY: Don't you 'good morning' us, you swindler!

BOB: Swindler? What did I do?

KATHY: **(mockingly)** What did I do?

JANE: You didn't tell us that Mr. Prescott would put ALL the campers with extra flashlight batteries on one team.

MARY: Yeah, that wasn't fair.

BOB: Of course it was fair. Mr. Prescott is the camp director. He has the right to reward those who are obedient doesn't he?

MARY: Well, yeah but...

BOB: Yeah, you chose to go rollerblading instead. You can't blame that on Mr. Prescott or me.

JANE: So are you saying that Mr. Prescott punished those who went rollerblading? Because if he did,

I...

BOB: Mr. Prescott explained it to you last night when he sent the losers away. But you were apparently not listening. This is exactly like the parable of the ten virgins. Those who were obedient and were ready would be rewarded, but those who were lazy or self-indulgent, and were not ready, would be sent away. You guys have nobody to blame but yourselves.

MARY: Guess I'll never do that again.

KATHY: Me either.

JANE: So, how were the SMORES?

BOB: Each one had TWO squares of chocolate.

JANE: Two squares of chocolate?

BOB: And TWO marshmallows.

KATHY: TWO marshmallows?

BOB: Maybe next time you'll remember our motto **(exits)**

MARY, KATHY & JANE: BE PREPARED! **(follow each other out)**

[END]

